

paper. Various printers offer different types of printing options, which you can use to suit your printing needs. Let's take a look at some of these options. Many printers also offer some kind of toner or ink saving mode, which lets you print really fast using much lesser ink. This is especially useful for printing drafts or rough copies of long documents.

The printer dialog box lets you print specific pages in a document, or a specific range of pages. You can also print multiple copies of the same document if you want. For more options you can click on the Properties button. This will let you do many things, such as select the resolution at which you want to print. A higher resolution uses more ink but gives better quality, and vice versa.

You can also choose to print on both sides of the paper, which comes in handy for things such as manuals or books. You can choose the size of your printing media, if you, say, want to print on envelopes or postcards. You can also change the orientation of your printout, so you can print in portrait or landscape mode.

Another very useful feature is the Print Preview option. This lets you see what your printout will look like after it's been printed, so wastage is minimised. You can even zoom in, and out of your document to get a better look at it. In most applications, this command can be accessed in the File menu by clicking on the Print Preview icon in your toolbar.

Do bear in mind that the exact options will differ with each printer model. The important thing is to be aware that they exist. So, whatever your printing demand, you know how best to meet the need.

Refilled and original cartridges

Inkjet printers are expensive to maintain primarily because of the high cost of cartridge replacements, and the costs incurred as a result of using poor quality cartridges.

It is very important to replace cartridges as soon as they dry up—keeping dried-up cartridges inside the printer for too long can clog the print head, causing poor quality printouts.

Users have an option of either using original cartridges or refilling them. Typically, users do not prefer original cartridges as they are expensive (Refill kits are available, which contain all the tools required for refilling inkjet cartridges at home). However, the problem with refill kits is that the ink provided with the kit cannot be used with all cartridges, since different cartridges have different standards. A single kit cannot provide a one-stop solution.

One could opt for compatible or replacement cartridges, which are printer cartridges manufactured by third parties or various OEMs. Compatible cartridges are generally of good quality and reliable because they are manufactured keeping in mind the specific printer model.

Another variety of cartridges that are extensively used these days

are recycled, also called re-manufactured cartridges. These are professionally recycled to guarantee high quality and good performance.

The bottomline is that there are reliable alternatives to refill cartridges, which are easy on pocket and at the same time, do not harm your printer.

New Interface For Printers

With the rapid growth in the usage of mobile devices such as handhelds and mobile phones that are capable of word processing, a need for printing the documents directly from these devices has led to the development of wireless printing solutions. And today we have many vendors coming out with printer models that support cutting-edge technology such as IrDA and Bluetooth.

IrDA is an acronym for Infrared Data Association. IR devices work using infrared technology, and hence don't require any cables to connect them to the printer. Using such printers, one can print

directly from a mobile device supporting IrDA interface without the need of any cables or even a PC. The only

shortcoming is the line of sight restriction—as the devices work using infrared rays, there should not be any obstacles between communicating devices.

Some HP printers with IrDA support are HP DeskJet 340, HP LaserJet 5MP, HP LaserJet 6MP, HP 2100M and HP4050N. Some of these are already available in India, and the rest will make it here before long.

Bluetooth is the latest addition to the ever-increasing plethora of interfaces available for printers.

Bluetooth is a low-cost, low-power, wireless radio frequency technology that allows various electrical devices to communicate with each other. These devices operate in the 2.4 GHz ISM (industrial, scientific, medical) band. One of the advantages of Bluetooth over IrDA is that close proximity between the communicating devices is not required, distances of up to 10 metres are allowed. Also, Bluetooth does not suffer from any line of sight restrictions.

A fascinating aspect of Bluetooth-enabled devices is their ability to communicate with each other spontaneously when they come within each other's range. Thus, a Bluetooth-enabled cell phone can be configured so that it can automatically print out all its stored messages using a Bluetooth printer as soon as you enter your office without any manual intervention. Another advantage of using Bluetooth is its support for point-to-multipoint communications. Thus, a single printer can simultaneously connect to both your cell phone, as well as your computer and any other Bluetooth-enabled device within its vicinity. The HP 995c Bluetooth printer is one such inkjet printer with built-in Bluetooth support, though it has yet to be available in India.





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